

Feminism



Health



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How Smuggling Groceries To The Starving Landed Me In Jail



Winter.of.Discontext 6 min read · Sep 3, 2025



A Mental Health Crisis, A Court System On A Vendetta, One Unforgivable Act of Compassion.

How I ended up smuggling groceries to a starving woman

From 2019 to 2021, I was in a love story so intense it felt like it bent the laws of physics. Days and nights melted into each other—antique hunts, epoxy disasters, spontaneous phonograph sessions, thrift store raids, and weird half-jokes turned half-truths. She moved me in during the early Covid lockdown—into a strange little kingdom made up of two teens, a rotating

tween, her other partner, and me. We made art, cooked elaborate meals for five, walked the empty streets in top hats like ghosts out of time, and tried to hold each other together.

Even as the center couldn't hold, she found me a job. That's the kind of wreckage it was—tangled and generous, even in collapse. We never stopped messaging. Letters, playlists, QR codes hiding voice memos. Even when we weren't together, we were.

Then CPS started showing up. Anonymous tips. Allegations inflated to absurdity—an argument at a grocery store twisted into a claim of beating her daughter ten times in public. The investigation found no cause for complaints.

But it was the wedge.

Not knowing where the complaints came from blamed everyone—her other partner, me, even her kids. Eventually, she traced it all back to her father, who disapproved of her home, her parenting, her life—and was about to put her on trial for it. Literally.

Too many people. Too much intensity. Too much love in too strange a shape.

And, with a legal maneuver that leveraged decade old divorce papers, and an absentee ex husband in another state, her father began dismantling our shared life.

She started unraveling. And so did I.

The Accusation

Her parents came for custody—using legal leftovers from her first marriage, propositioning her ex, and lavishing gifts on her daughter. Under pressure and already slipping into early-stage psychosis, she lashed out in every direction.

I went downhill, fast. Then I moved out. Devastated. Bankrupt in every way except emotionally—because emotionally, I was still in it. Still receiving texts. Still hiding our continued connection from her other boyfriend. Still bringing antiques to drop-offs we pretended weren't romantic.

Then, one day, she told me to delete our entire message history.

I didn't.

But then she vanished.

I spiraled. Messages. Letters. Some desperate, some angry, some full of that old impossible love. I begged her to stop the lies I feared she was preparing. I'd seen her do it before—to others. I knew the pattern. But I didn't know how far it would go.

One day I was pulled over for expired tags. Then handcuffed.

And told it was for “stalking.”

Had I messaged her? Yes—mostly in response to hers. Hundreds of them. Thousands. Had I dropped off things? Yes—at her request. Had I contacted her after she told me not to? In the past, yes—we both had blocked each

other; and we had both broken the silence. After she told me to erase everything and then ghosted me. That's when I panicked. I threatened to sue her for partial ownership of the antiques business we had started together.

It wasn't stalking, it was preemptive self-defense. From what, I wasn't yet sure. But you don't just tell someone to delete your shared history unless you've got plans that make that history a problem.

I was answering her messages. I was reacting to a situation that was falling apart in real time. My messages weren't threats. They were peace offerings frayed by fear: My fear—of her.

The Deal

Still struggling with covid-related employment chances, my lawyer charged me thousands. I scraped it together.

He replied to a single email from the prosecutor. Prosecutor: "Thinking what I'm thinking? CPO." My own defense attorney: "Otherwise it'll be a day or two trial full of love declarations."

They never reviewed the evidence. Never let me speak. Never gave me a chance to explain that I wasn't the one doing the contacting. Never even allowed me into the closed door proceedings.

Then I agreed to sign it. Because every reason I gave that it was bogus landed on deaf ears, every alternative I suggested was waved away dismissively without consideration.

It was the only choice I was given. Once accused, you cannot fight. Because to this court, context doesn't matter. At all.

I gave in because it is what I thought she wanted. That there'd be no hearing. That the order was "just a no-contact thing." They didn't tell me it was in a separate court. Under a different number. Impossible to locate or modify.

I told my lawyer, "She'll contact me again." He shrugged.

I said, "This will cost me my job." He said it wouldn't. Verbally. Then he reversed himself when I asked via email.

I lost the job.

What I didn't know is that my name had already been used in her custody case. That she, or her parents—or both—had primed the court to see me as a threat. And that I'd never be able to defend myself again.

"You agreed." Said my attorney.

"Under duress" I said.

"Did you have a gun to your head?"

Because it seems that's what it takes to undo a court order conceived under duress by the requester, lightly agreed to by the defendant's own counsel. And completely unchallengeable within a system that will admit no wrong.

The Years of Silence

From late 2022 through early 2024, I followed the order. Zero contact.

Then came the first message.

Then another.



Then dozens.

She had totally lost the custody battle for her daughter. She was starving. Alone. Broke. Unemployable.

She was scared.

And I... ignored her. Like I'd been told to.

Until I couldn't anymore.

The Docket Disappears

She said the order was lifted.

I didn't believe her. I checked the online docket—the same one I'd used before. The case was gone. Not sealed. Not dismissed. Just... disappeared.

And so I helped. I fed her dogs. Cleaned her dishes. Fixed the washing machine. Mowed the lawn. Repaired the plumbing. Brought food. Hauled groceries.

We weren't "back together." She was barely the person I'd loved. She'd stopped eating. Barely slept. Talked to herself in the mirror for hours.

Her teenaged son had been her caretaker. Then her ex husband had the son removed by the court. The same court. Now he was gone, too. Again, citing me as a reason. Once smeared, I had become the go-to excuse.

But the order had been lifted.

The Trip

On her birthday in 2025, I brought scallops and filet mignon. Her favorites. For a few hours, she smiled. Laughed. Asked me to trip with her again—like the old days.

Last time she'd asked, I'd refused. Miffed, she'd taken too much on her own. Her anger turned to rage, borderline violence.

So this time, I said yes.

Because what's worse than babysitting a schizophrenic while you're tripping?
Babysitting an angry schizophrenic while she's taken twice as much.

I don't remember much. The police found me naked in the street at 3am. The body cam shows I was polite, if disoriented. I called one officer's bald head "shiny." He laughed.

Then they arrested me.

Homeless (According to Them)

I was released barefoot. No phone. No keys. No wallet. Wearing a GPS ankle monitor.

I was told I couldn't go back to get my stuff. Because the protection order was still active.

So I walked.

When I finally got my keys and left the exclusion zone, I got pulled over again. Field sobriety test. I passed. They searched my car. No drugs.

Later, I learned I'd violated the order by walking too close to her house. Even though I'd given them my address, they now called me homeless.

I missed work. Again. Lost another job.

The System Isn't Broken. It's Working Exactly As Designed.

I was prosecuted for a crime that didn't exist, based on messages she sent.

I was excluded from negotiations about my own rights.

I was told not to show up to court.

I was given an order I couldn't locate—let alone understand.

I was forbidden from helping someone everyone else expected me to help—her family, her doctors, even her.

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Write



The Groceries That Got Me Charged

She messaged me again. “I have no food. I’m starving. Please help.”

I picked her up. Took her to the store. Carried bags to her door.

Then my phone buzzed.

“You’ve entered the exclusion zone. One more time and you’re going to jail.”

Would I do it again?

Honestly?

Yes.

She's sick. The system is cruel.

Someone had to carry the groceries.

- Feminism ✓
- Health +
- Justice ✓
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Written by Winter.of.Discontext

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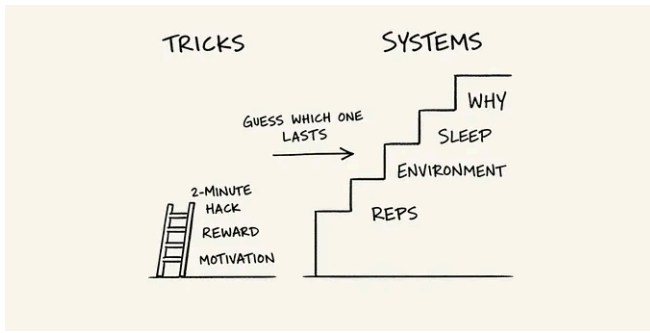
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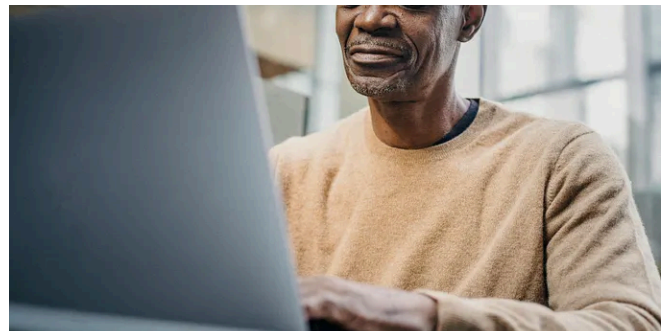


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